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Last updated: July, 2026

Education

New York University — NYC, USA
Ph.D., Communicative Sciences and Disorders — 2021–2026
- Dissertation Title: *Use and impact of linguistic accommodations in interactions with autistic individuals*
- Advisor: Dr. Sudha Arunachalam

Jawaharlal Nehru University — Delhi, India
M.A. in Linguistics — 2016–2018

English and Foreign Languages University — Hyderabad, India
B.A. (Hons) in English — 2013–2016

Publications

Under Review / In preparation

[1] **Shukla**, **V.**, He, A. X., & Arunachalam, S. (under revision, second round). *Tuning of unscripted parent narratives directed to autistic and non-autistic children: An exploratory eye-tracking study.*

[2] **Shukla**, **V.**, Jaswal, V., & Arunachalam, S. (in preparation). *Impact of accommodated speech on autistic adults' comprehension and evaluation of the speaker.*

Published

[3] **Shukla**, **V.**, Jaswal, V., & Arunachalam, S. (in press). Linguistic accommodation made by non-autistic speakers in response to being told the listener is autistic. *Acta Psychologica.*

[4] Arunachalam, S., Carroll, L., Lee, R., Luyster, R., Margolis, B., & **Shukla**, **V.** (2026). Autistic parents and autistic children: Using the double empathy model in the context of language use and development. In Y. Ortega, M. B. Rosa, S. Canagrajah, & N. Walker (Eds.), *Handbook of neurodiversity and applied linguistics.* Routledge. [author order is alphabetical].

[5] Ben-Ami, S., **Shukla**, **V.**, Gupta, P., Shah, P., Ralekar, C., Ganesh, S., Gilad-Gutnick, S., Rubio-Fernández, P., & Sinha, P. (2024). Form perception as a bridge to real-world functional proficiency. *Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*, *46*.

[6] Rubio-Fernandez, P., Long, M., **Shukla**, **V.**, Bhatia, V., Mahapatra, A., Ralekar, C., Ben-Ami, S., & Sinha, P. (2023). Multimodal communication in newly sighted children: An investigation of the relation between visual experience and pragmatic development. *Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*, *46*.

[7] **Shukla**, **V.**, Long, M., & Rubio-Fernandez, P. (2022). Children's acquisition of new/given markers in english, hindi, mandinka and spanish: Exploring the effect of optionality during grammaticalization. *Glossa Psycholinguistics*, *1*(1).

[8] Rubio-Fernandez, P., **Shukla**, **V.**, Bhatia, V., Ben-Ami, S., & Sinha, P. (2022). Head turning is an effective cue for gaze following: Evidence from newly sighted individuals, school children and adults. *Neuropsychologia*, *174*, 108330.

[9] Rubio-Fernandez, P., Long, M., **Shukla**, **V.**, Bhatia, V., & Sinha, P. (2022). Visual perspective taking is not automatic in a simplified dot task: Evidence from newly sighted children, primary school children and adults. *Neuropsychologia*, 108256.

[10] **Shukla**, **V.**, Long, M., Bhatia, V., & Rubio-Fernandez, P. (2021). Some sentences prime pragmatic reasoning in the verification and evaluation of comparisons. *Journal of Experimental Psychology: Learning, Memory, and Cognition*.

[11] Long, M., **Shukla**, **V.**, & Rubio-Fernandez, P. (2021). The development of simile comprehension: From similarity to scalar implicature. *Child Development*, *92*(4), 1439–1457.

[12] Yadav, H., Vaidya, A., **Shukla**, **V.**, & Husain, S. (2020). Word order typology interacts with linguistic complexity: A cross-linguistic corpus study. *Cognitive Science*, *44*(4), e12822.

Conference Presentations

- **Impact of accommodated speech on autistic people's evaluation of the speaker** Boston, USA, 2026
  Vishakha Shukla, Vikram Jaswal, Sudha Arunachalam
  Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing
- **Linguistic accommodation in autistic and non-autistic dyads in response to "autism" label** New Orleans, USA, 2026
  Vishakha Shukla, Vikram Jaswal, Sudha Arunachalam
  Linguistic Society of America Annual Meeting
- **Attention to illustrations in autistic and non-autistic children following spontaneous parent narratives: An exploratory eye-tracking study** Nijmegen, The Netherlands, 2023
  Vishakha Shukla, Angela Xiaoxue He, Sudha Arunachalam
  Many Paths to Language
- **Multimodal referential communication in newly-sighted children: When do they look at their interlocutor's face?** Nijmegen, The Netherlands, 2023
  Vrinda Bhatia, Vishakha Shukla, Anwesha Mahapatra, Madeleine Long, Paula Rubio-Fernandez
- **Parental tuning of narratives directed to autistic and non-autistic children: An exploratory eye-tracking study** Durham, USA, 2023
  Vishakha Shukla, Angela Xiaoxue He, Sudha Arunachalam
  Meeting on Language in Autism
- **Comprehension of unscripted parent narratives by autistic children** Wisconsin, USA, 2022
  Vishakha Shukla, Angela Xiaoxue He, Sudha Arunachalam
  2022 Symposium on Research in Child Language Disorders
- **Eliciting narratives in diferent languages, cultures and platforms: methodological insights.** Virtual, 2021
  Vrinda Bhatia, Anwesha Mahapatra, Vishakha Shukla, Paula Rubio-Fernandez
  MODE: Methods of Online Discourse Elicitation Conference
- **Children's acquisition of new/given markers in English, Hindi, Mandinka and Spanish** Virtual, 2021
  Vishakha Shukla, Madeleine Long, Vrinda Bhatia, Paula Rubio-Fernandez
  34th CUNY Conference on Human Sentence Processing
- **Priming pragmatic reasoning in the verification and evaluation of comparisons** Virtual, 2021
  Vishakha Shukla, Madeleine Long, Vrinda Bhatia, Paula Rubio-Fernandez
  34th CUNY Conference on Human Sentence Processing
- **Perspective taking in newly-sighted kids** Boulder, USA, 2019
  Paula Rubio-Fernandez, Vishakha Shukla, Shlomit Ben Ami, Chetan Ralekar, Ashwini Vaidya, Michelle Oraa Ali, Pawan Sinha
  32nd CUNY Conference on Human Sentence Processing
- **Cross-linguistic comparison of crossing dependencies using psycho-linguistically motivated measures** Hyderabad, India, 2018
  Vishakha Shukla, Himanshu Yadav, Ashwini Vaidya, and Samar Husain
  AMLaP-Asia

Teaching and Work Experience

Speech and Language Development — NYU Communicative Sciences and Disorders
Adjunct Professor — Spring, 2025

Science of Language — NYU Communicative Sciences and Disorders
Teaching Assistant — Fall 2023, 2024, 2025

First Language Acquisition — NYU Linguistics
Teaching Assistant — Spring 2023

Project Prakash, MIT — New Delhi, India
Research Assistant — 2018-2021

Fellowships and Awards

- Steinhardt Dissertation Finishing Award — 2025
- Steinhardt Research & Travel Grant, NYU — 2024,2025
- Travel Bursary, Max Planck Institute for Psycholinguistics — 2023
- Student Travel Award, SRCLD — 2023

Service

- Member of Committee for Considerations for Autistic Populations, ASHA (2023)
- Founded Neurodiversity Journal Club at CSD, NYU
- Undergraduate research mentor SHARE-CSD (2023, 2024)